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Grid Wire — Week of June 15, 2026

Texas energy & AI-infrastructure intelligence. Window: June 8–15, 2026, with clearly-flagged early-June context. Every item traces to a dated primary or first-tier source; widely-circulated stories that failed date-checking are excluded.

The Lede — Texas stops courting AI load and starts pricing it

Two actions eight days apart redefined the Texas large-load market. On **June 1–2** the ERCOT board endorsed **"Batch Zero"** (PGRR145 / NPRR1325) — the transitional framework that moves data-center interconnection from one-at-a-time studies to batch allocation of transmission headroom, with queue priority tied to demonstrated flexibility and a qualification/security fee reported in the **$50,000–$100,000/MW** range. On **June 10**, Governor Abbott ordered the PUC and ERCOT to ensure new data centers **fully fund their own grid infrastructure** and that interconnections lower residential bills — with hard deadlines (joint memo **July 17**, PUC action to cut residential transmission costs **July 31**) and a promise of next-session legislation to repeal the data-center sales-tax exemption and mandate closed-loop cooling.

The throughline: the buildout pipeline is now so large — roughly **438 GW** of large-load requests, >5× the all-time system peak, ~90% data centers — that the marginal policy question has flipped from "how much load can we attract" to "who pays, and on what terms." Cost-causation, mandatory curtailability (75 MW+ loads now legally interruptible), and bring-your-own-generation are hardening from talking points into rules. For anyone underwriting a Texas interconnection, land position, or counterparty, the value now sits with **flexible, self-funded, generation-paired** load — and against speculative grid-only requests.

Capital markets did not wait for the rules: **June 9–11 alone** saw an investment-grade Texas data-center bond (**Hut 8, $4.25B**), a **$35B** chip-backed Apollo/Broadcom/Anthropic facility, and **$3.5B** of CoreWeave notes price at a ~9.6% USD coupon. Morgan Stanley now sees **~$570B** of AI-related debt issuance in 2026, roughly double 2025.

By the Numbers

Figure	What	Source
438 GW	ERCOT large-load interconnection requests (early 2026); ~200 data centers / large users. Firmer figure was ~226 GW Nov 2025 — headline is inflated by speculative/duplicate filings.	ERCOT via Houston Public Media
~100 GW	Load volume Batch Zero is designed to study in batches	RTO Insider
92.2 GW	ERCOT summer-2026 peak-demand forecast (92,211 MW) vs. **85.5 GW** record (Aug 10, 2023). EEA probability **0.09% June / 0.21% July**.	KERA / Community Impact
$50–100k/ MW	Reported large-load qualification / financial-security fee (Batch Zero + SB6 §25.194)	RTO Insider; Greenberg Traurig
$4.25B	Hut 8 Beacon Point IG bond, 6.129%, Baa2/BBB−, 352 MW campus in Nueces County, TX	PR Newswire
$35B	Apollo/Blackstone capital solution for Broadcom "XPV Platform" / Anthropic (>1 GW → 20+ GW)	Apollo IR; Axios
~$570B	Morgan Stanley forecast: 2026 AI-related global debt issuance (~2× 2025)	Reuters via Tech Startups
$25B (+~$40B)	Japan pledge to NuScale + US SMR supply chain; separate ~$40B to GE Vernova-Hitachi BWRX-300	SEDaily; FPJ
$411M	7th Texas Energy Fund In-ERCOT loan — Rayburn Electric, 570 MW gas, Sherman, COD 2028	Office of the Governor
$350M	Texas TANEO advanced-nuclear grants; first awards expected ~July 2026	Utility Dive

ERCOT & the Texas Grid

Batch Zero clears the ERCOT board; PUC vote is the next gate (not yet done). The board endorsed the transitional large-load rules June 1–2; they go to the PUC for approval at its **June 18** open meeting, target effective **July 10**. The package adds a **Provisional Controllable Load Resource (PCLR)** pathway letting loads energize early under SCED curtailment while transmission upgrades are built. CEO Pablo Vegas pitched the ~100 GW framework as a template other RTOs could adopt. Read: this is the machinery that converts a 438 GW paper queue into studied, committed load — and it explicitly rewards curtailable, flexible demand. Source: RTO Insider · Houston Public Media

Summer 2026 outlook: adequate, but the record-peak math is live. ERCOT's operational weather outlook leans near-normal and is explicitly "not forecasting another record-breaking summer," while the load forecast still carries a potential peak above **92 GW** vs. the 85.5 GW record. EEA (emergency) probability is pegged at **0.09% in June, 0.21% in July**. Recent supply adds cited: ~5 GW battery, ~4 GW solar, ~1.5 GW gas. This is also the **first summer under RTC+B** (real-time co-optimization + batteries, live since Dec 5, 2025) — the first hot-weather read on the new ancillary-services construct (ASDCs replaced the ORDC). Source: KERA · Community Impact

Texas Energy Fund keeps disbursing — 7th In-ERCOT loan to a co-op. The PUC finalized a 20-year, 3%, up-to-**$411M** TEF loan (≈60% of a sub-$685M cost) to **Rayburn Electric Cooperative** for a **570 MW** gas plant near Sherman (ERCOT North), COD 2028 — the seventh finalized In-ERCOT loan and a signal that cooperatives, not just IPPs, are landing dispatchable-gen capital. Separately, the PUC executed its **third Completion Bonus Grant** (May 28) with **Calpine** — up to $55.2M for the 460 MW Pin Oak Creek peaker (Freestone County). Note the program clock: last day for initial disbursements on approved In-ERCOT loans is **Dec 31, 2026**. Source: Office of the Governor · Calpine

Transmission: ~$6.5B of projects cleared TAC; the 765 kV backbone advances. ERCOT's Technical Advisory Committee endorsed roughly **$6.5B** in transmission projects on May 19. The state's first 765 kV extra-high-voltage backbone (Oncor/AEP Western Loop, multi-utility Eastern Loop) continues through the RPG/CCN pipeline; the Permian Basin Reliability Plan's three 765 kV import paths were approved April 2025, with AEP Texas building one of the first lines. Watch CCN actions as the Abbott cost-shift directive reshapes who pays for these upgrades. Source: Texas Energy & Power · RTO Insider

Structural backdrop: solar overtakes coal; storage near 14 GW. ERCOT solar generation surpassed coal for the first time in March 2026 and is forecast to stay above it through year-end. Texas entered 2026 with **~13.9 GW of battery capacity** (nearly double a year earlier), and ERCOT expects **15–20 GW of new resources** in 2026, heavily solar + storage. Source: U.S. EIA · Modo Energy

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Data Centers & Large Load

The macro map (best single reference this week). The Texas Tribune's June 8 survey counts **≥248 planned data centers** and **519 ERCOT connection requests** over two years (vs. 24 the prior year), **~438,595 MW** requested (~90% data centers); regional split 86 North Texas / 56 Central / 45 West; max planned single site ~10,800 MW. New facilities need ~5× the capacity of existing Texas data centers, and water use could reach **3–9% of statewide demand by 2040** (from <1% today). Notably, ERCOT is not assessing whether enough electricity exists — supply is assumed market-driven. Source: Texas Tribune

The co-located template: Google/Intersect break ground on the Meitner Energy Center (Panhandle). On June 4, Google and newly-acquired Intersect Power broke ground in Gray/Roberts Counties: four data-center buildings drawing up to **840 MW**, paired on-site with **>1 GW** of wind/solar/battery plus gas backup and ~3 GWh storage — generation and load permitted as one complex. Part of Google's ~$40B Texas push through 2027. This is the cleanest "generation-first" campus model now setting the Texas template — exactly the structure Batch Zero rewards. Source: POWER Magazine · DCD

Supply side: NRG commissions its first new plant in a decade. On June 11 NRG brought online the **456 MW** TH Wharton gas peaker near Houston, financed via a Texas Energy Fund loan — units start in ~30 minutes on ERCOT call. Not data-center-dedicated, but it is the supply answer to the same demand curve and validates TEF as a working fast-start-gas channel. Source: Axios Houston · NRG IR

The rural-county revolt is now the siting risk. A June 2 deep-dive on **Hood County** captures the statewide friction: eight proposed projects across 7,600+ acres — led by Sailfish Investors' **Comanche Circle** (~3 GW across three projects, 2,100 acres, $5–20B tax-base potential) and **Pacifico Energy's Fort Spunky** (100 MW, 862 acres). Texas counties lack zoning authority; two moratorium votes failed, Pacifico sued the county for $250k+ over a revoked concept plan, and Sen. Bettencourt warned the AG against county moratoriums. Directly relevant to LRP's Pacifico/GW Ranch counterparty work — the same developer, the same playbook, now litigating local control. Source: Texas Tribune · Texas Observer

Curtailability is now law, not courtesy. Texas statute requires new loads of **75 MW+** interconnecting from 2026 onward to accept **mandatory curtailment** during firm load-shed events. Combined with Batch Zero's flexibility incentives, interruptibility is now hard-coded into the Texas large-load value proposition — central to how ERCOT plans to absorb hundreds of GW without proportional firm capacity. Source: Texas Tribune

Standing context (not a new event): the Abilene flagship is not growing past 1.2 GW. Crusoe/Oracle's 1.2 GW Stargate I continues completing buildings on GB200 racks, but the 600 MW expansion to ~2.0 GW **remains canceled** (financing + OpenAI demand re-forecast, originally March 2026); the Nvidia ~$150M deposit and Meta-takes-the-lease talk are unresolved. For the LRP Stargate diligence file: the answer to "does Abilene grow" is still no. Source: DCD

Capital & Financing — an unusually heavy debt week

Hut 8 closes the first Baa2 data-center project bond — and it's in Texas. June 9: Beacon Point DC LLC closed **$4.25B** of 6.129% senior secured notes due 2042 (fully amortizing from 2030), priced at **T+165bp** — 20bp inside Hut 8's April deal — rated **Baa2/BBB−/BBB−**, non-recourse to parent. Funds a 352 MW, six-hall campus on ~521 acres in **Nueces County, TX**, pre-leased to an undisclosed AA−-or-higher tenant. J.P. Morgan lead. The investment-grade notch, on a Texas asset, is the read-through: project-level DC debt is maturing into the IG market. Source: PR Newswire

The structural deal of the week: Apollo's $35B chip-backed facility for Broadcom/Anthropic. June 9: Apollo and Blackstone anchor a **$35B** financing for Broadcom's "XPV Platform," initially funding >1 GW of compute for Anthropic and scaling toward 20+ GW through 2028. Reporting describes a chip/lease-backed SPV with Google backstopping lease payments at Fluidstack-operated sites (TeraWulf, Cipher, Hut 8 as operators). No coupon disclosed. Vendor + hyperscaler credit support layered into private-credit — the template for how the next leg gets funded. Source: Apollo IR · Axios

CoreWeave prints $3.5B — and the coupon tells you where neocloud credit sits. Priced June 11: **$1.25B at 9.625%** (USD) + **€2.0B at 8.500%**, both due 2032, unsecured. Against >$17.3B total debt, ~10.7× debt/equity, and a $4.2B principal repayment due later in 2026, a ~9.6% unsecured coupon is the market's price on neocloud risk. Source: BusinessWire

The aggregate: ~$570B of AI debt in 2026. Morgan Stanley (June 10) sees 2026 AI-related global debt issuance near **$570B**, ~4× the year-earlier pace through May, against ~$700B of 2026 hyperscaler capex (projected >$1T in 2027), with issuers pushing into non-USD markets. Source: Reuters via Tech Startups

Supply chain + converts. Super Micro (June 9) launched **$7.0B** of equity/equity-linked financing to fund ~$39B of booked AI-server orders — and shares fell ~20% intraday on the dilution. Keel Infrastructure (June 9) closed **$458M** of **1.250%** convertible notes due 2032 (~25% conversion premium) to fund long-lead equipment for its data-center pipeline — a reminder that converts let developers raise cheap capital against equity upside. Source: Supermicro · DCD

The credit watch-items. SoftBank (June 4) is shopping a margin loan **collateralized by its OpenAI stake** — lenders balk because the shares lack a continuous price; SoftBank CDS reportedly ~360bp, with a recent 10-yr tranche at an 8.5% coupon. Oracle reported record Q4/FY26 (June 10) on ~$50B FY26 capex guidance, but its CDS sits near post-2009 highs (>125bp) on the OpenAI-concentration story. And the swing variable under all the GPU-backed paper is **residual value**: Blackwell B300 lead times are compressing (~36→18 weeks) into the Rubin transition, pressuring rental rates and ABS depreciation assumptions (rating frameworks now stress ~50% value at yr 3, ~10–20% at yr 5). Source: Benzinga · Techi

Advanced Nuclear

The financing wave is the story: Japan commits ~$25B to NuScale + US SMR supply chain. June 12–13: Japan is in final talks to commit up to **$25B** to NuScale and a US SMR supply chain, framed around AI/data-center load — alongside a separate ~**$40B** commitment to GE Vernova-Hitachi's **BWRX-300** program (Tennessee/Alabama, ~3 GW), pushing cumulative Japanese US-nuclear investment toward ~$65B. It's a supply-chain/financing pledge, not contracted offtake — conversion-to-revenue is the watch item. Source: SEDaily · Foreign Policy Journal

Oklo clears a DOE safety gate and integrates manufacturing. June 11: DOE approved the **Preliminary Documented Safety Analysis** for Oklo's first Aurora powerhouse at INL — a key step on the Reactor Pilot Program pathway toward construction while NRC commercial licensing runs in parallel. Days earlier (announced June 8, closed June 4) Oklo **acquired ARMEC**, an Oak Ridge precision-manufacturing shop, to bring fabrication in-house across its reactor and fuel programs. Source: World Nuclear News · BusinessWire

Europe's order book moves: Sweden picks Rolls-Royce SMR. June 15: Videberg Kraft (Vattenfall + Industrikraft, state to become majority owner) selected the **Rolls-Royce SMR** (470 MWe PWR) over the BWRX-300 for **three units (~1.5 GW)** near Ringhals, first unit mid-2030s — Sweden the third European country to choose RR SMR. Separately, **Studsvik** (June 12) sought state support for up to **1,400 MW** of LWR SMRs at two sites. Source: World Nuclear News — Sweden/RR · WNN — Studsvik

The Texas thread is anticipatory — TANEO awards are the catalyst. Texas's **$350M** Advanced Nuclear Energy Office grant program (HB 14) closed applications May 14; **first recipients are expected ~July 2026** (eligibility requires a docketed NRC construction-permit/license application or reasonable expectation by Dec 1, 2026). The freshest Texas-adjacent developer news is **X-energy** entering the UK Generic Design Assessment for its Xe-100 (June 2) — the same reactor behind the **Dow Seadrift, TX** cogeneration project (Amazon offtake up to 5 GW by 2039). And the national read-through for Texas's pilot reactors (Last Energy at A&M-RELLIS; Natura MSR-1 at ACU) racing the **July 4 DOE criticality goal**: Antares' Mark-0 became the **first reactor critical under the DOE Pilot Program** on June 4. Source: Utility Dive — TANEO · WNN — X-energy · POWER — Antares

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Policy & Regulation

Texas

Abbott's cost-shift directive is the week's most market-moving Texas signal. June 10: the Governor directed the PUC to require data centers to **fully fund** their serving infrastructure so costs don't fall on residential ratepayers — joint PUC/ERCOT memo due **July 17**, PUC action to reduce residential transmission costs due **July 31 —** and pledged legislation to repeal data-center sales-tax exemptions, mandate water-efficient cooling, and require usage reporting. It pressures the pending SB6 rule toward the strict end and puts the tax exemption explicitly on the table — load-side underwriting and siting economics both move. Source: Office of the Governor · RTO Insider

SB6 large-load rule (§25.194) is pending, not adopted. Proposed March 12, comments closed April 17; adoption expected later in 2026 (statutory deadline Dec 31). The draft governs loads ≥75 MW with non-refundable fees (reported $50–100k/MW in some scenarios), financial security with forfeiture for delay/withdrawal, site-control proof, and affiliate/parallel-project disclosure. A parallel transmission cost-allocation proceeding (Project 58484) is moving toward replacing 4CP and eliminating large-load interconnection cost allowances. Source: Greenberg Traurig · DLA Piper

Federal

Court restores the 5% safe harbor weeks before the July 4 cliff. June 6: a D.C. district court vacated IRS Notice 2025-42 (which had killed the 5% begin-construction safe harbor for wind and solar >1.5 MW under §§45Y/48E), finding the IRS acted arbitrarily under the APA. Effect: the **5% safe harbor is restored** (subject to appeal/revised guidance) **less than a month before the July 4, 2026 OBBBA begin-construction deadline** to preserve full-value credits — materially de-risking late-stage wind/solar racing the cliff, including ERCOT's heavy solar/storage pipeline. Source: Holland & Knight

FERC's national large-load order is imminent (committed by end of June — not yet out). Following its April 16 "intent to act," FERC committed to issue an order in the **RM26-4** large-load docket **by end of June 2026 —** potentially touching jurisdiction, interconnection process, co-located load/generation treatment, and cost allocation. Watch for it at/around the **June 18** open meeting; it sets the national template that interacts with ERCOT's intrastate approach. Source: FERC · Holland & Knight

Section 232 tariff reset took effect June 8. A June 1 White House proclamation restructured metals tariffs effective **June 8** through Dec 31, 2027: 25% baseline on most steel/aluminum/copper, a reduced **15%** rate for certain industrial machinery, and goods with ≤15% metal content exiting 232 entirely. Importers of transformers, switchgear, and grid equipment must re-map exposure — direct capex and lead-time implications for ERCOT transmission build-out and generator interconnection. (Treat transformer-specific rates as directional pending line-item confirmation.) Source: C.H. Robinson

DOE "Speed to Power" 202(c) orders keep plants online; expirations land this window. Active emergency orders (Schahfer & F.B. Culley, IN; Craig Unit 1, CO) run through **June 21 / June 28**; the Campbell (MI) coal-delay order is being litigated on authority grounds. No new Texas/ERCOT 202(c) order this week, but the litigation outcome shapes whether DOE keeps delaying thermal retirements — a precedent ERCOT-adjacent owners are watching. On financing, DOE LPO continues Palisades restart disbursements (~$491M to date) with $12.5B of advanced-nuclear loan authority open. Source: DOE — 202(c) · DOE — Palisades

The Read — what it means for LRP

1. **The premium is migrating from "has an interconnect" to "is curtailable and self-powered."** Batch Zero, the 75 MW+ mandatory-curtailment rule, and Abbott's full-funding directive all reward the Google/Intersect Meitner template (generation-paired, flexible) and penalize speculative grid-only requests. The 438 GW queue will shrink hard as fees and security forfeiture bite — underwrite to the firmer ~226 GW reality, not the headline.
2. **West Texas land theses cut both ways.** The same flexibility/BYO-gen regime that favors Permian behind-the-meter plays (GW Ranch, Fermi, Pacifico) also imports the SB6 cost-allocation and curtailment overhang onto any grid-tied load. Hood County shows the live downside: Pacifico is litigating a Texas county over a revoked concept plan. Local control (or its absence) is now a priced siting risk.
3. **The capital window is open but repricing.** IG money will fund Texas data-center assets (Hut 8/Nueces), but neocloud credit prints near 9.6% and the GPU residual-value debate is sharpening the ABS math. Counterparty quality up the stack (Oracle CDS, SoftBank's OpenAI-collateral problem) remains the transmission cable — consistent with the Stargate-Abilene finding that the asset is sound and the offtake chain is where the risk lives.
4. **Two federal shoes drop within two weeks.** The FERC RM26-4 order (end of June) and the restored 5% safe harbor into the July 4 cliff will move the solar/storage and co-location economics that sit underneath nearly every Texas large-load deal. Position now; both are calendar-certain catalysts, not speculation.

On the Calendar

Date	Event
Jun 18	PUC open meeting — Batch Zero approval expected; FERC June open meeting
late Jun	FERC RM26-4 large-load order committed
Jun 21 / 28	DOE 202(c) emergency orders expire (IN / CO)
Jul 4	OBBBA begin-construction cliff (wind/solar 45Y/48E); DOE Reactor Pilot ≥3-criticality goal
Jul 10	Batch Zero target effective date
Jul 17	PUC + ERCOT joint memo to Governor (data-center cost protections)
Jul 31	PUC must initiate action to cut residential transmission costs
~Jul	Texas TANEO first advanced-nuclear grant awards
by Dec 31	SB6 §25.194 adoption deadline; last day for TEF In-ERCOT initial disbursements

Grid Wire · Land Resource Partners · Compiled June 15, 2026. Methodology: five-lane fan-out research (ERCOT/market, data centers, AI-infra financing, advanced nuclear, policy), every item date-checked against a primary or first-tier source. Items that failed verification — e.g. recycled 2018/2023 ERCOT summer-heat coverage, 2025-

vintage nuclear deals re-tagged "June 2026," and out-of-window data-center ABS — were excluded. Not investment advice; internal and peer circulation.